



COPILOT ZERO TO HERO

Bi-Weekly Bootcamp Series. Expert-Led Hands-on Sessions.



Carike Botha
Chief AI Scientist, MVP



Setting up Power Platform environments and an Azure AI landing zone for any custom Copilot extensions, ensuring connectivity and governance for advanced scenarios.

SESSION 7: PREPARING POWER PLATFORM & AZURE



AGENDA

- Introduction
- Setting Up Power Platform Environments 🚀
- Establishing an Azure AI Landing Zone 🏗️
- Custom Copilot Extensions – Building and Integrating 🤖
- Tools and Resources for Success 🧰
- Practical Exercises and Homework 📋

ORGANISERS & PRESENTERS



Tracy van der Schyff
Microsoft's #1 Fan, MVP



Jacqui Muller (Soup Kitchen De Vil)
VP of Everything, UiPath MVP



Carike Botha
Chief AI Scientist, MVP



Jason Baxter
The Solution Guy, Microsoft



Alistair Pugin (Hennie De Wet)
Shouting at ECM, MVP



Warren du Toit
Azure Legend, Microsoft

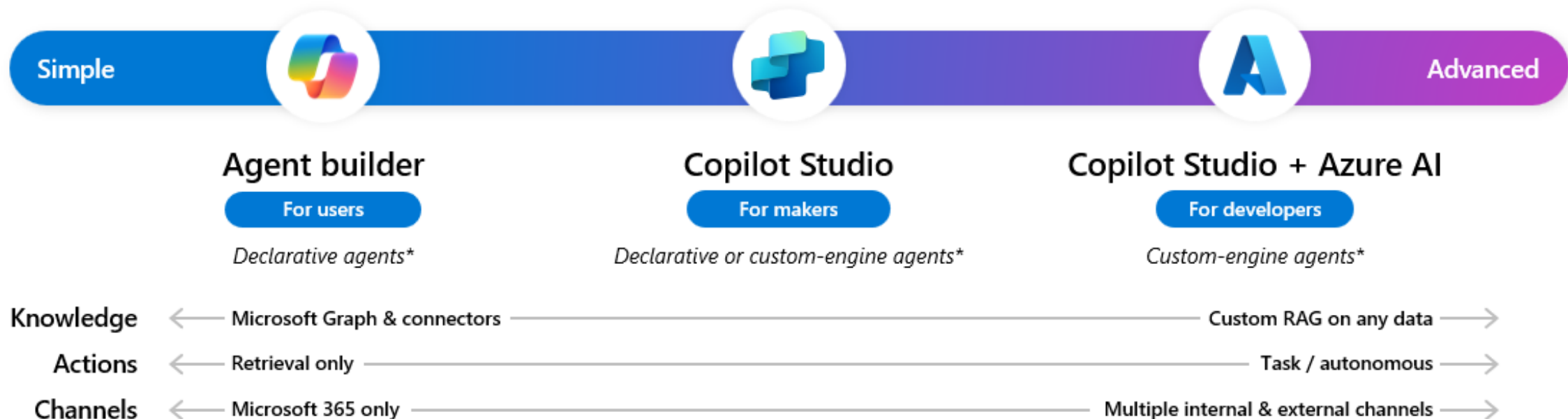
BI-WEEKLY SESSIONS



DATE	SPEAKER	TITLE	LINK
15th Jul 2025	Jason Baxter	Session 1: The Three Strategies you need for AI	Past
29th Jul 2025	Tracy van der Schyff	Session 2: Assembling your AI Council: First steps	Past
12th Aug 2025	Carike Botha	Session 3: Creating a Plan for Copilot Deployment	Past
26th Aug 2025	Alistair Pugin	Session 4: Preparing the Tenant	Past
9th Sept 2025	Jacqui Muller	Session 5: Preparing SharePoint Online	Past
23rd Sept 2025	Warren du Toit	Session 6: Preparing Teams (Meetings) for Recording & Transcription	Past
7th Oct 2025	Carike Botha	Session 7: Preparing Power Platform & Azure	YOU are here
21st Oct 2025	Jason Baxter	Session 8: Creating a Communication Plan	Register
4th Nov 2025	Alistair Pugin	Session 9: Rolling Out Copilot Chat	Register
18th Nov 2025	Jacqui Muller	Session 10: Rolling Out "Tips and Tricks" Sessions	Register

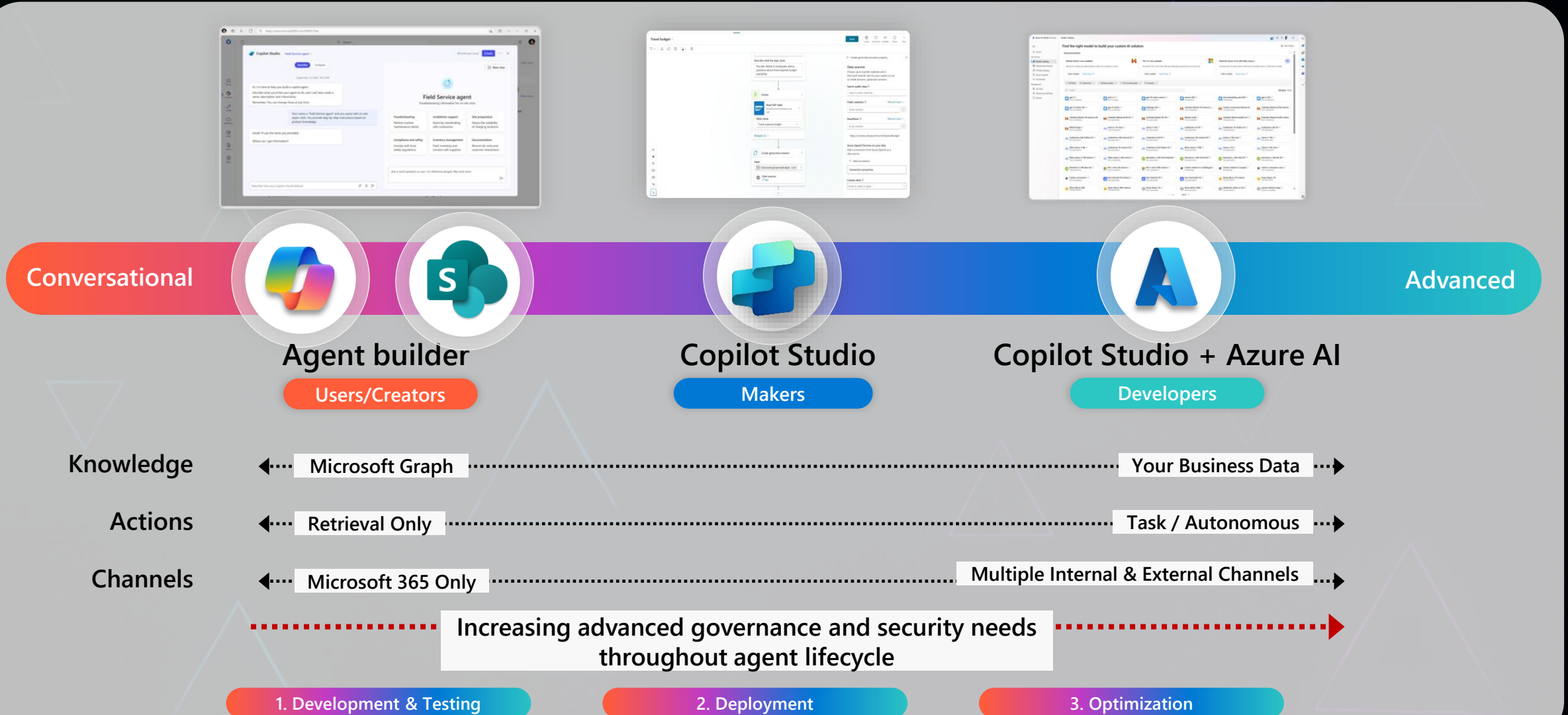
INTRODUCTION

TOOLS TO CREATE AGENTS

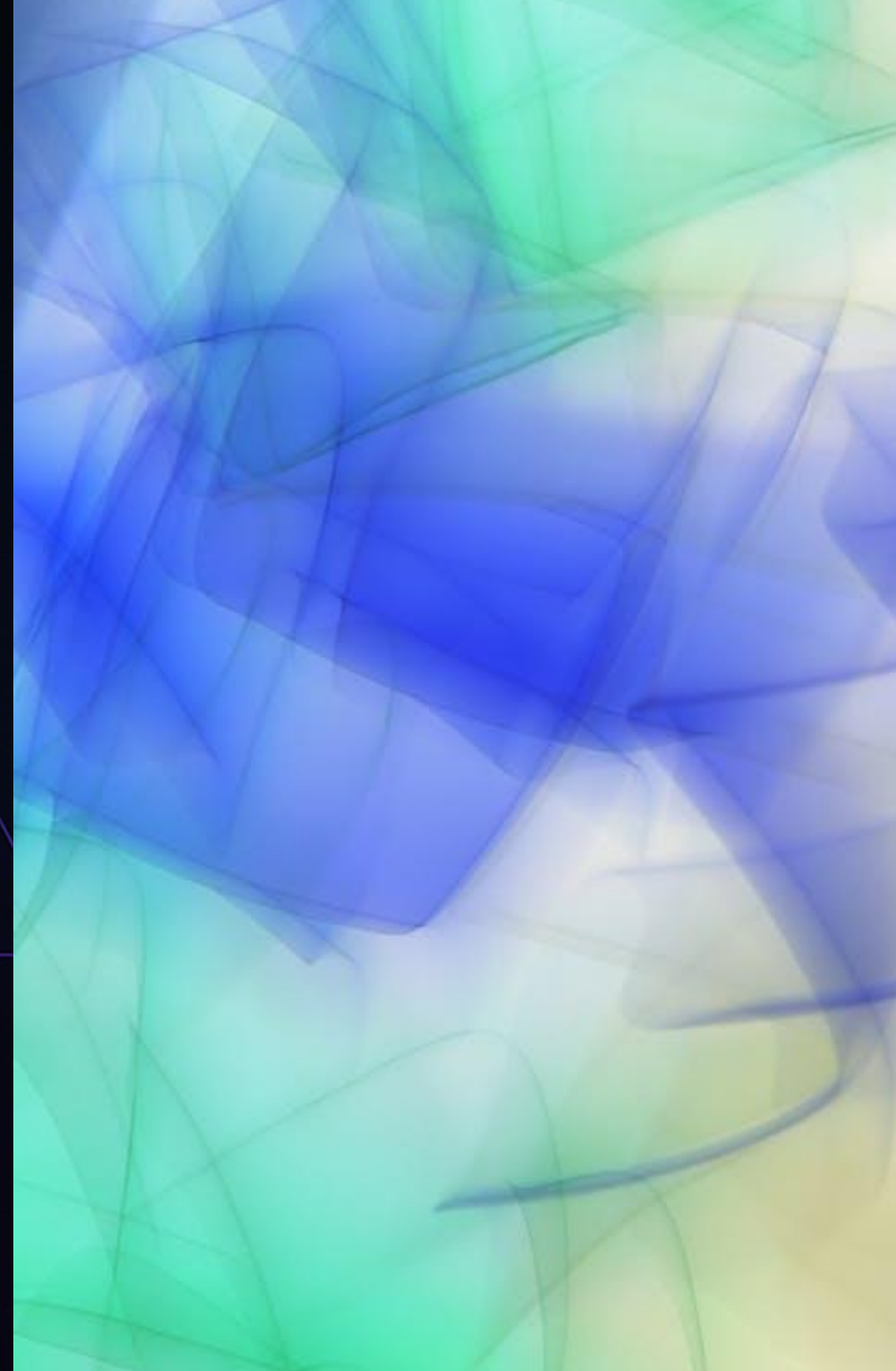


* Declarative = prompts handled by Microsoft 365 Copilot; Custom-engine = prompts handled by custom AI engine (i.e., orchestrator and foundation models)

ADVANCED AGENTS REQUIRE MORE ADVANCED GOVERNANCE AND SECURITY



SETTING UP POWER PLATFORM ENVIRONMENTS 🚀



PLAN ENVIRONMENT STRUCTURE

Define an environment strategy early to guide your solution lifecycle.

Use environments logically:

- Development: for building and experimenting.
- Test/UAT: for quality assurance and user acceptance.
- Production: for live, stable applications.

Provide more flexibility to advanced makers

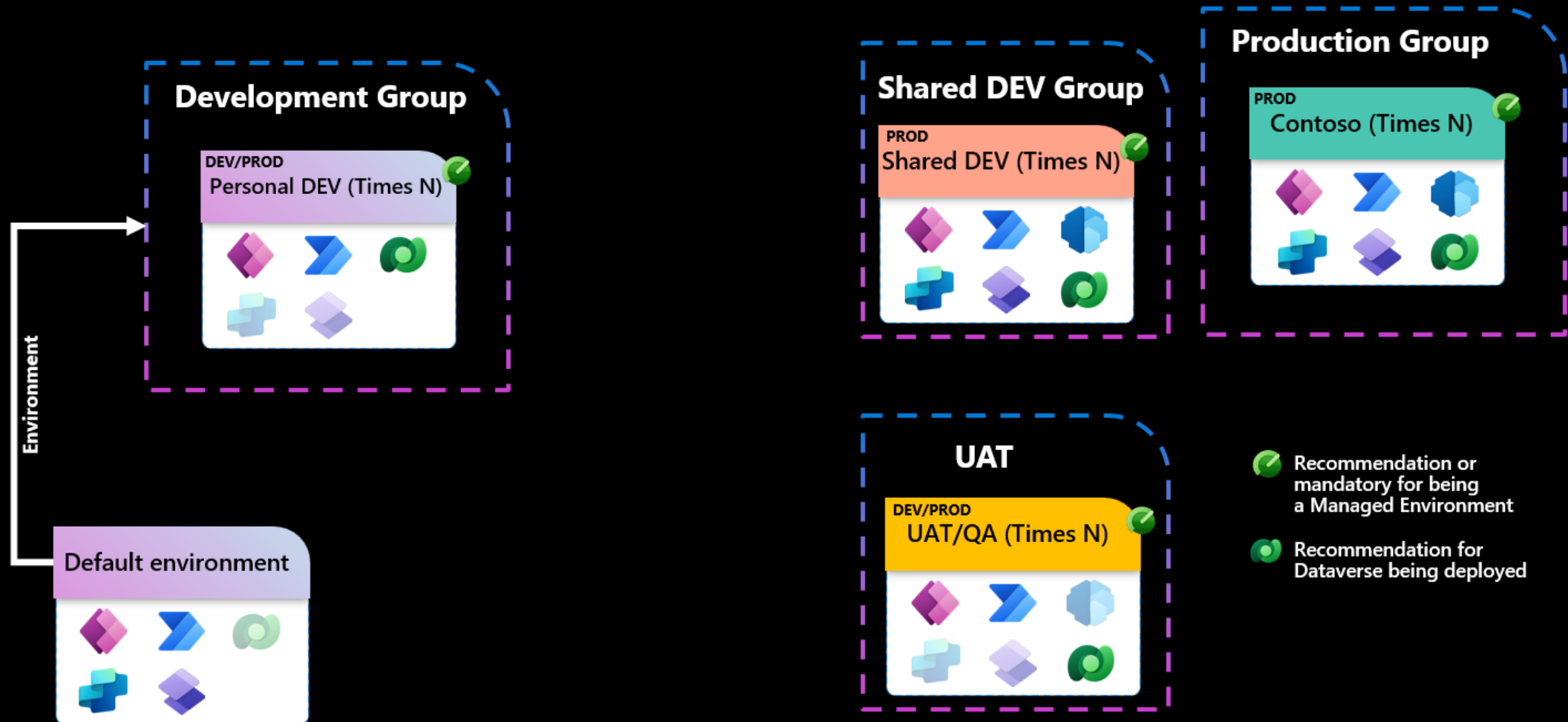
Identify common levels of security for your environments and the features that protect each level

Decide on the number and purpose of environments—typically Development, Test/UAT, and Production.

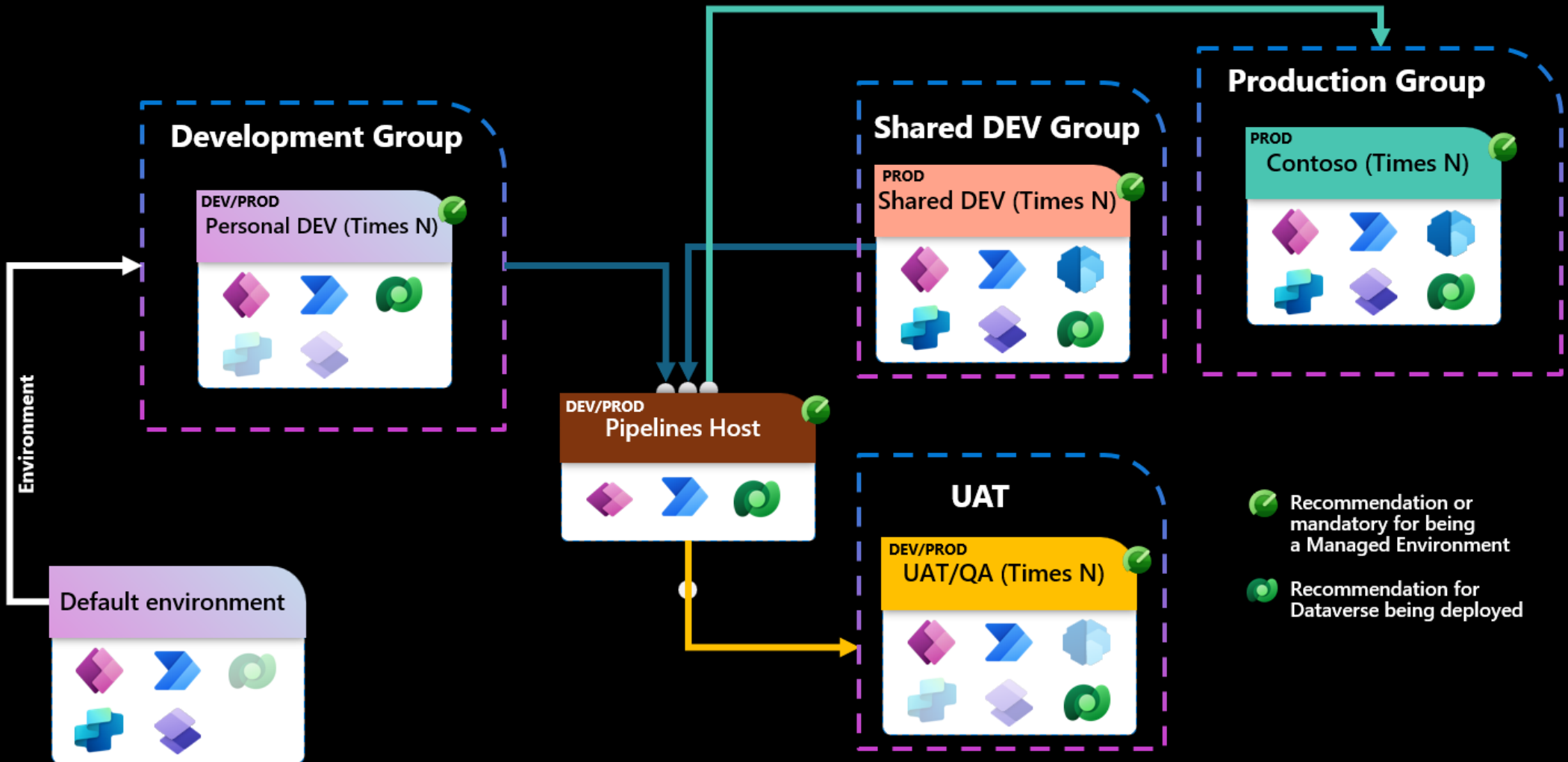
Control which makers can create developer environments

Organize developer environments by region or business unit

FOUNDATION OF AN ENTERPRISE-SCALE ENVIRONMENT STRATEGY



FOUNDATION OF AN ENTERPRISE-SCALE ENVIRONMENT STRATEGY



ADDITIONALLY

Set Security Roles and Permissions

Enable Monitoring and Alerts

Use the Center of Excellence (CoE) Starter Kit

Establish DLP policies to govern connector usage across environments. DLP allows you to classify connectors as "Business" or "Non-Business" (or Blocked) and prevent mixing sensitive data connectors with non-approved services in the same app/flow

Mark as Managed Environments (Optional) - By marking an environment as "Managed," admin oversight is simplified - you get governance features like weekly digest reports of app usage, easier sharing controls, and the ability to automatically clean up unused resources.

ESTABLISHING AN AZURE AI LANDING ZONE 🏗️



WHAT IS AN AZURE AI LANDING ZONE?



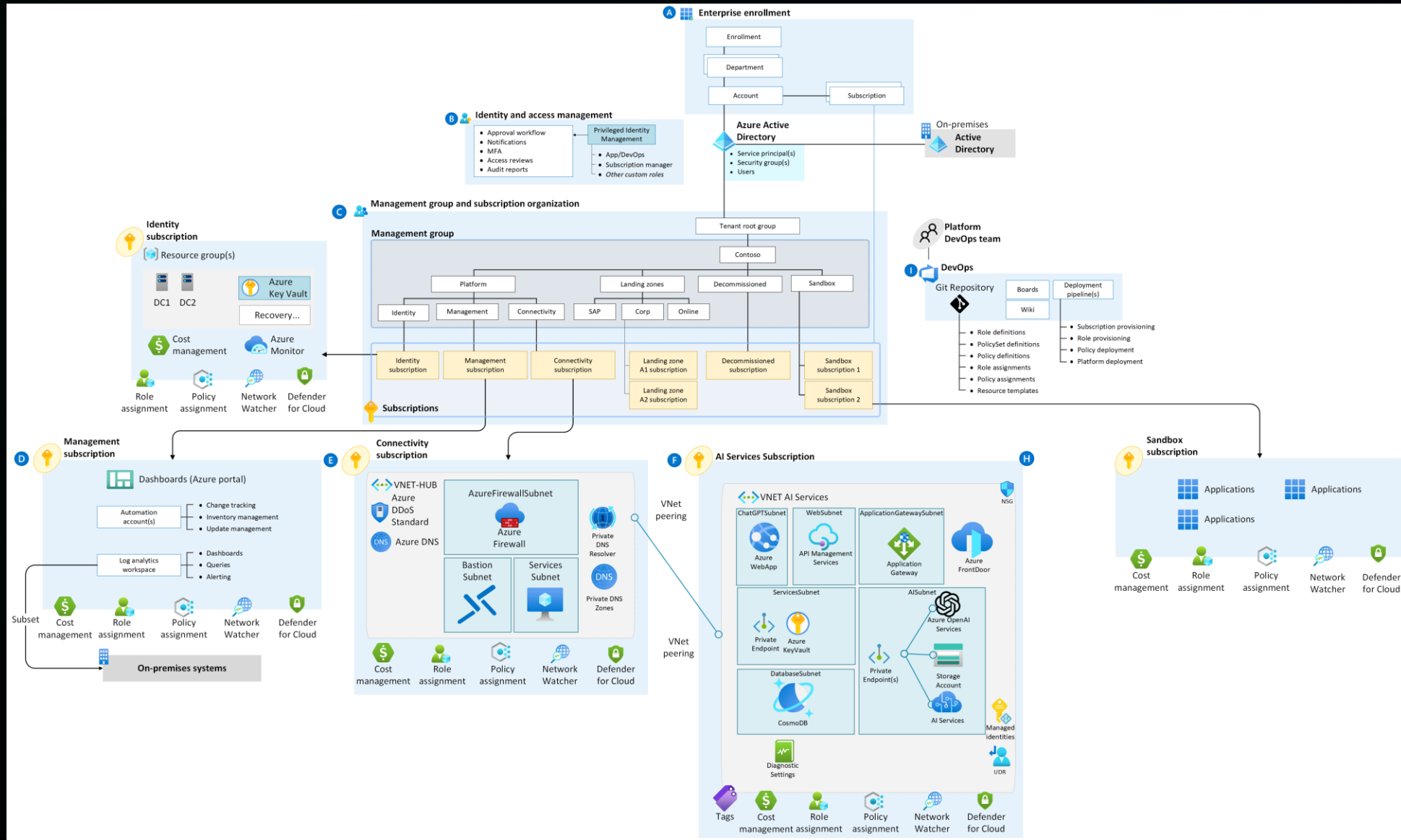
- Think of it as the foundation on which any AI-related resources will be built.
 - When deploying complex AI services such as Azure OpenAI, using a Landing Zone approach helps you manage resources in a consistent, governed way, ensuring compliance and security are maintained.

AZURE LANDING ZONES TYPICALLY ADDRESS THESE DESIGN AREAS



- Governance Boundaries
- Secure Networking
- Connectivity to Data Sources
- Identity and Access Management
- Resource Organization
- Azure Policy and Compliance
- Compute and GPU Planning

AZURE OPENAI LANDING ZONE REFERENCE ARCHITECTURE



STEP-BY-STEP: BUILDING THE LANDING ZONE (HIGH-LEVEL)



- Create a resource hierarchy – Management Groups and Subscriptions for AI.

Setup Core Infrastructure



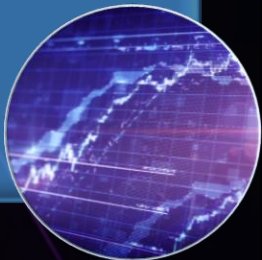
- In an AI shared services subscription, set up the virtual network topology. This could include a hub VNet (with subnets for various services), integrated with your on-prem network if needed (via ExpressRoute or VPN). Deploy security services like an Azure Firewall or configure a WAF. Also configure Private DNS Zones if your AI services will use private endpoints (so that they can resolve correctly within the network).

Networking and Connectivity



- Set up solutions for monitoring and logging, such as Azure Monitor (Log Analytics workspaces, Application Insights) and enable diagnostics on all critical services. Also deploy guardrails like Azure Policy definitions and Initiatives (collections of policies)

Deploy Management and Monitoring



STEP-BY-STEP: BUILDING THE LANDING ZONE (HIGH-LEVEL)



- In the workload subscription (e.g., AI-Dev), deploy the needed AI resources:
 - If you are extending Copilot or building custom AI, you might deploy an Azure OpenAI Service instance (for GPT models) or an Azure Machine Learning workspace (to train custom models).
 - Possibly deploy Azure Cognitive Services (like Language, Vision, etc.) as needed.
 - Deploy supporting services: e.g., an Azure Storage account or Data Lake for training data, Azure SQL/Cosmos DB for any persistent data, or Azure API Management if you plan to expose your AI model via APIs.

Provision AI Services:



- If your custom Copilot extension will call an Azure API, make sure to configure API endpoints and authentication. Often, you will use Azure API Management (APIM) as a gateway in front of your AI services. APIM can publish a friendly, secure API endpoint for your Copilot (or other consumers) to call.

Ensure Connectivity for Copilot Extensions



- Before going live, test the landing zone setup.

Testing and Validation



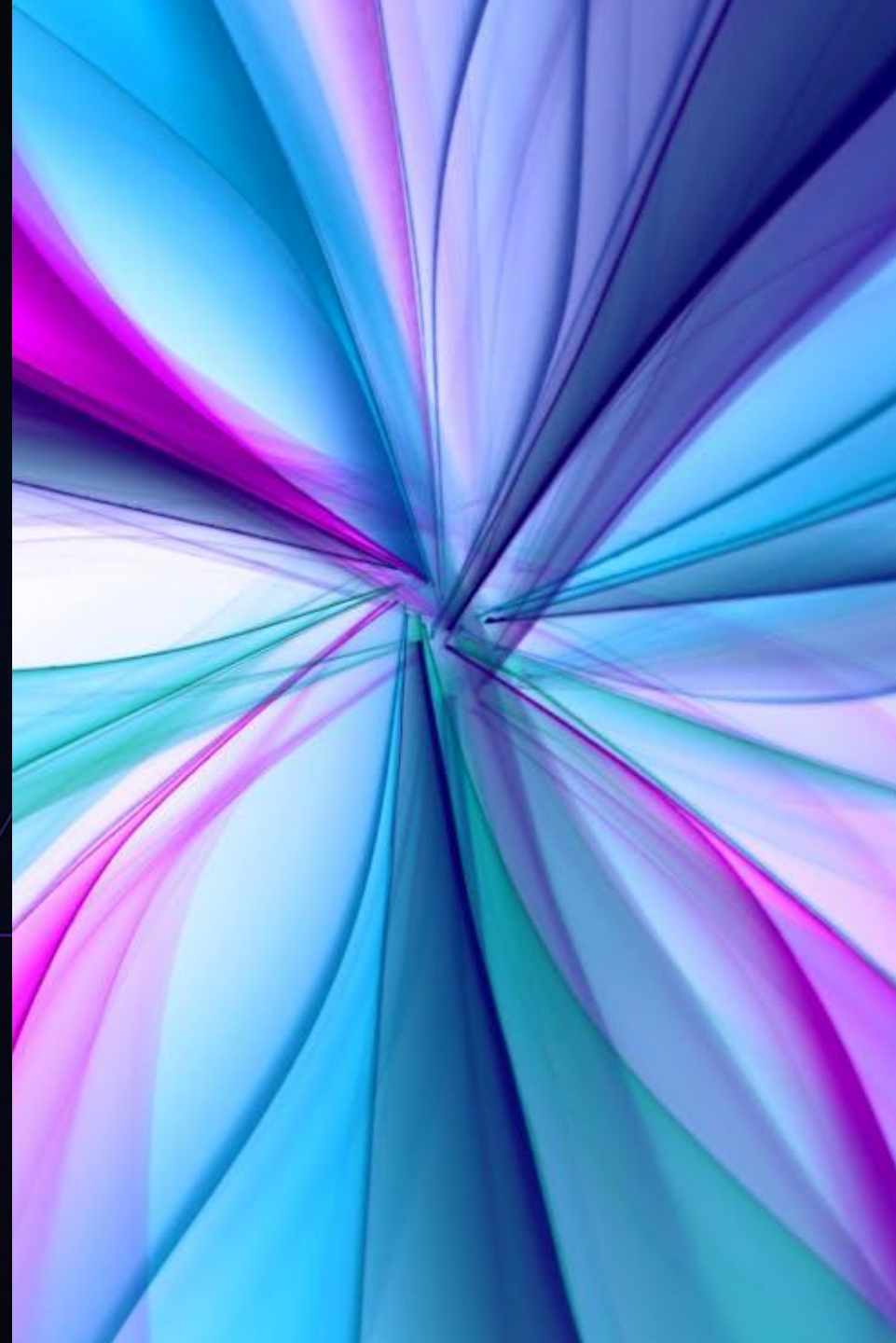
STEP-BY-STEP: BUILDING THE LANDING ZONE (HIGH-LEVEL)

- Establish routines to manage this landing zone:
 - Implement access reviews for Azure RBAC roles.
 - Use cost management tools to track AI service usage (AI can be compute-intensive, so you'll want cost alerts).
 - Plan for scaling: ensure the landing zone can scale with more users or more projects – e.g., have a process to create new resource groups or even new subscriptions if a big project comes along.
- Have a disaster recovery plan: If an AI service is mission-critical, deploy it across regions (multi-region deployment) to avoid a single point of failure. For instance, if using Azure OpenAI in East US, you might also provision a replica in West US and have a failover plan.

Operationalize



CUSTOM COPILOT
EXTENSIONS -
BUILDING AND
INTEGRATING



EXTEND COPILOT WITH YOUR OWN DATA & ACTIONS

Build your own Copilot using plugins, connectors, and agents

Use Copilot Studio to create low-code extensions

Connect Copilot to internal systems (e.g. ERP, CRM)

Enable Copilot to retrieve data or perform actions

HOW TO BUILD & SECURE YOUR EXTENSION



Expose APIs
securely
(OAuth, Azure
AD)

Use Graph
Connectors
for data
indexing

Apply
governance &
permissions
carefully

Register
plugins via
Copilot
Studio

Test in
sandbox,
monitor
usage

TOOLS AND RESOURCES FOR SUCCESS

GOVERNANCE, ADOPTION & DEVELOPMENT RESOURCES



Microsoft Learn:

Secure & govern Power Platform environments

Community & Licensing:

Forums, blogs, and licensing guides

Adoption Guidance & Workbook:

Align business goals with platform strategy

ALM & DevOps Tools:

CI/CD pipelines for Power Platform

CoE Starter Kit:

Dashboards, automation, app usage insights

Managed Environments:

Built-in governance features

AI-READY INFRASTRUCTURE & LEARNING PATHS



Azure Architecture Center:

Reference diagrams for AI solutions

Case Studies & ROI Tools:

Real-world examples & value calculators

Azure OpenAI Docs:

Secure setup & sample code

Azure Monitor & Sentinel:

Telemetry & anomaly detection

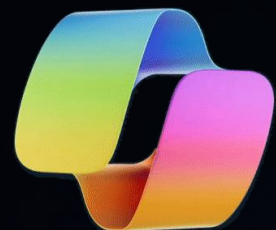
Terraform/Bicep Modules:

Automate landing zone deployment

Microsoft Learn:

Azure governance, networking, monitoring

HOMEWORK



COPILOT

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THANK YOU